

TEAM SWOT ANALYSIS ASSIGNMENT

There are many tools that are used by managers to analyze an organization and develop strategies to move it towards gaining or maintaining competitive advantage. One of the primary models used is the SWOT analysis.

Your team will analyze CMU as its organization through the lens of the SWOT model. This assignment has 3 parts.

PART I – MATRIX AND ID OF SWOT AND STRATEGIES

Your team will begin by creating a SWOT matrix. Within that matrix, your team will list your **TOP 3** of each of the SWOT categories.

After your team has identified what it believes are 3 of the top strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats for CMU, your team will offer its **TOP 3** strategies in each category (SO / WO / ST / WT) that CMU can launch in order to maximize its success going forward.

PART II – ANALYSIS OF SWOT

For this section, your team will break out each major category (SWOT) and analyze each of its 3 choices within each major category. In doing so, consider the following:

- Why did you choose each specific choice within each category? (For example, what about each point has merit?)

PART III – ANALYSIS OF STRATEGIES

For this section, your team will break out each strategy (SO / WO / ST / WT) and analyze each of its 3 chosen strategies within each major category. In doing so, consider the following questions:

- Why did you choose each specific strategy within each category? (For example, what about your strategy has merit?)
- What outcomes do you expect CMU to experience as a result of implementing each strategy?
- How might your strategies help CMU achieve or maintain a competitive advantage?
- *NOTE – You may connect any internal S and W to any external O and T to create your strategies. You may use the same internal S and W and external O and T more than once.*

ASSIGNMENT NOTES

- Your team will complete the SWOT matrix in the specified MS Excel spreadsheet. This will be both submitted electronically in Canvas as a separate document to your paper and printed and submitted on the scheduled due date.
- When highlighting any data in support of your SWOT points or strategies (for example, external trends that can be considered opportunities for CMU or external threats to CMU), make sure to cite where you found these trends so that I may follow up if I desire.

- When considering specific points within each SWOT category, you must take a macro perspective. Then, as you analyze each point, you may get more micro in the specifics of your analysis. (For example, threats may include local universities as competition. However, that would be 1 point, not multiple points. As you analyze what local universities as competition means, you should highlight specific schools, programs, etc.)

TEAM PROCESS NOTES

I recommend the following team process:

- Each team member completes their own points for each SWOT area and strategies that match up with their points (with references to external sources).
- The team comes together to consensus as to what it believes are the top 3 points for each major SWOT category, and the strategies that they would employ thereof.
- The team divides up the work among the team members (each one takes responsibility for one section (SWOT), while collaborating on strategies together (for example, the member responsible for Strengths collaborates with those responsible for Opportunities and Threats to formalize and analyze SO and ST strategies.)
- It is the team leader's job to work with all team members and sub-teams to ensure work is being done with a focus on quality, that agreed upon deadlines are achieved, and that members feel supported if they have questions or need some assistance.

PRESENTATION NOTES

- Make sure to separate each section out and answer each question and sub-question directly so I know that you have considered it in depth.
- Remember to follow presentation directions from the *Writing Business Papers* document!
 - Single space throughout, please!
- Remember to review the assignment rubric on Canvas!
- Complete sections in order and do NOT combine sections.
- Cite sources within analyses. No need for appendices.
- Consider 2 – 3 paragraphs of analysis per point and strategy.
- Use the template provided for you on Canvas to complete your paper.